

CIVIL RIGHTS GROUP SUBMITS TO INQUIRY

An examination of the books of the Civil Rights Congress was begun yesterday by a joint legislative committee seeking to determine whether that and other organizations were diverting to propaganda purposes funds collected in the name of philanthropy.

The Civil Rights Congress, having lost two court decisions on its challenge of the committee's subpoena, delivered books and records to Jacob J. Rosenblum, special counsel to the legislative investigators, at 270 Broadway. The examination will continue today.

The joint committee, headed by State Senator Bernard Tompkins and Assemblyman Samuel Rabin, both Queens Republicans, carried out last year an investigation of charity rackets. The committee's exposure at public hearings in December and January resulted in new laws regulating fund raising by professionals and requiring reports by all except religious organizations.

Among the further investigations the committee said it would make this fall was an inquiry into the use of "philanthropic" funds for propaganda, either Communist or for the extreme right.

It is expected that public hearings into this phase of the investigation will start here next month. The committee staff is now examining the records of several organizations to see where the contributed money ultimately went.